

FOR EVERY K-12 STUDENT NEW TO THE UNITED STATES
POU TOUT ELÈV K-12 KI FÈK RIVE OZETAZINI

Your guide to school in the U.S.

Gid ou pou lekòl Ozetazini

How American schools work, what happens your first week, what your grades mean, what your rights are, and the words everyone uses — explained simply, for you and your family.

Kijan lekòl yo fonksyone, sa k ap pase nan premye semèn ou, sa nòt yo vle di, ki dwa ou genyen ak mo tout moun itilize — eksplike yon fason senp, pou ou menm ak fanmi w.

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2 How schools in the U.S. are organized

Kijan lekòl yo òganize Ozetazini

ENGLISH

School is **free and required** for every child, usually from age 5 or 6 to 16–18 (it depends on the state). You do not need to be a citizen, and the school cannot ask your immigration status to enroll you. Public schools are run by a local **school district**, and each state sets its own rules — so a few details will be different where you live.

KREYÒL AYISYEN

Lekòl la **gratis epi obligatwa** pou tout timoun, anjeneral depi 5 oswa 6 an jiska 16–18 an (sa depann de eta a). Ou pa bezwen sitwayen, epi lekòl la pa gen dwa mande estati imigrasyon w pou enskri w. Se yon **distri eskolè** lokal ki dirije lekòl piblik yo, epi chak eta gen pwòp règ pa l — kidonk kèk detay ap diferan kote w ap viv la.

The grade levels · Nivo klas yo

School · Lekòl	Grades · Klas	Ages · Laj	What it is like · Kijan li ye
Elementary school Lekòl primè	K (kindergarten) – 5	5–11	One main teacher, one classroom, recess (play time). Yon pwofesè prensipal, yon sal klas, rekreyasyon.
Middle school (junior high) Premye sik segondè	6 – 8	11–14	Students change rooms and teachers for each subject; lockers; more homework. Elèv yo chanje sal ak pwofesè pou chak matyè; kazye; plis devwa.
High school Lekòl segondè	9 – 12	14–18	Students earn credits toward a diploma. 9 = freshman, 10 = sophomore, 11 = junior, 12 = senior. Elèv yo ranmase kredi pou diplòm nan.

Your grade is set by your age and past schooling, **not** by your English level. A 15-year-old newcomer goes to high school and gets English support *inside* that grade.

Se laj ou ak etid ou te fè anvan ki deside nan ki klas ou ye, **pa** nivo anglè w. Yon nouvo elèv ki gen 15 an antre nan lekòl segondè (high school) epi li resevwa sipò nan anglè *anndan* klas sa a.

Kinds of schools

- **Public** — free, paid by taxes, open to every child in the district. Most students go here.
- **Charter** — free and public, run by its own board; you apply.
- **Magnet** — public, with a special focus (science, arts, languages).
- **Private** — families pay tuition; religious schools are usually private.

Kalite lekòl

- **Piblik** — gratis, taks yo peye l, louvri pou tout timoun nan distri a. Pifò elèv ale la.
- **Charter** — gratis epi piblik, ak pwòp konsèy administrasyon pa l; ou dwe fè demann.
- **Magnet** — piblik, ak yon espesyalite (syans, atizay, lang).
- **Prive** — fanmi yo peye lekòl; lekòl relijye yo anjeneral prive.

The school year

- About **180 days**, usually **August to May** (some states: September to June).
- Divided into **semesters** (2 halves) or **quarters / nine-weeks** (4 parts). Report cards come at the end of each.
- Breaks: Thanksgiving (late Nov.), winter break (~2 weeks, Dec.–Jan.), spring break (1 week), summer (June–Aug.).
- Monday–Friday, about 7:30–8:30 a.m. to 2:30–3:30 p.m.

Good to know: the U.S. uses the 12-hour clock (8:00 a.m., 2:45 p.m.), Fahrenheit temperatures, and letter grades A–F. "College" means university. "Grade" means both your year in school (9th grade) and your score (a grade of B).

Ane eskolè a

- Apeprè **180 jou**, anjeneral **soti out rive me** (nan kèk eta: septanm rive jen).
- Li divize an **semès** (2 mwatye) oswa **trimès / nèf semèn** (4 pati). Kanè yo soti nan fen chak pati.
- Vakans: Thanksgiving (fen nov.), ivè (~2 semèn, des.–jan.), prentan (1 semèn), ete (jen–out).
- Lendi rive vandredi, apeprè 7:30–8:30 a.m. rive 2:30–3:30 p.m.

Bon pou konnen: Ozetazini yo itilize revèy 12 èdtan (8:00 a.m., 2:45 p.m.), tanperati an Fahrenheit, ak nòt an lèt A–F. "College" vle di inivèsite. "Grade" vle di ni ane w nan lekòl (9th grade) ni nòt ou (a grade of B).

3 Enrolling and your first week

Enskripsyon ak premye semèn ou

ENGLISH

What to bring to enroll

Go to the school office or the district enrollment center. Bring what you have — **missing papers cannot stop you from starting school.**

- ☐ **Proof of age** — birth certificate, passport, or any official record
- ☐ **Proof of address** — lease, utility bill, or a letter from the person you live with
- ☐ **Vaccine record** — the nurse can help you get missing shots, often free
- ☐ **Past school records** — in any language; they place you in the right grade and can give you credit
- ☐ **Parent/guardian photo ID** — a Social Security number is **not** required

You will fill out a **Home Language Survey**. If another language is spoken at home, the school tests your English and may offer EL services. That is support, not punishment.

KREYÒL AYISYEN

Sa pou w pote pou enskri

Ale nan biwo lekòl la oswa nan sant enskripsyon distri a. Pote sa w genyen — **papye ki manke pa ka anpeche w kòmanse lekòl.**

- ☐ **Prèv laj** — ak nesans, paspò oswa nenpòt dokiman ofisyèl
- ☐ **Prèv adrès** — kontra lwaye, bòdwo kouran oswa yon lèt moun ou rete lakay li a
- ☐ **Kanè vaksen** — enfimyè a ka ede w jwenn vaksen ki manke yo, souvan gratis
- ☐ **Ansyen kanè oswa sètifika lekòl** — nan nenpòt lang; yo sèvi pou mete w nan bon klas la epi yo ka ba w kredi
- ☐ **Pyès idantite ak foto paran/gadyen an** — yo pa mande nimewo Sekirite Sosyal

W ap ranpli yon **Sondaj sou Lang Lakay** (Home Language Survey). Si yo pale yon lòt lang lakay ou, lekòl la ap teste anglè w epi li ka ofri w sèvis EL. Se yon sipò, se pa yon pinisyon.

People who will help you · Moun k ap ede w

Principal	Leads the school. Assistant principals handle discipline and schedules.
Counselor	Makes your schedule, helps with problems, plans graduation and college. Go here first.
EL / ESL teacher	Teaches you English and helps your other teachers support you.
Office secretary	Absence notes, forms, late passes, calling home.
Nurse	Illness, medicine, vaccine records.
Interpreter / liaison	Translates for families. Ask for one — it is your right and it is free.

Direktè/Direktris	Dirije lekòl la. Direktè adjwen yo okipe disiplin ak orè.
Konseye	Fè orè w, ede w ak pwoblèm, planifye gradyasyon ak inivèsite. Kòmanse la.
Pwofesè EL / ESL	Aprann ou anglè epi ede lòt pwofesè w yo sipòte w.
Sekretè	Nòt absans, fòmilè, pèmi pou reta, apèl lakay.
Enfimyè	Maladi, medikaman, vaksen.
Entèprèt / Iyezon	Tradui pou fanmi yo. Mande youn — se dwa w epi li gratis.

DAY 1 · JOU 1

Get your schedule, locker and student ID. Find the office, cafeteria and bathrooms. Learn your bus number. Pran orè w, kazyè w ak kat idantite elèv ou. Jwenn biwo a, kafeterya a ak twalèt yo. Aprann nimewo bis ou.

DAY 2 · JOU 2

Meet each teacher; write their name and room number. Ask for the syllabus. Rankontre chak pwofesè; ekri non yo ak nimewo sal la. Mande syllabus la (plan klas la).

DAY 3 · JOU 3

Log in to the school computer system and email. Many schools lend you a Chromebook. Konekte nan sistèm enfòmatrik lekòl la ak imèl la. Anpil lekòl prete w yon Chromebook.

DAY 4 · JOU 4

Take the English placement test. Relax — it only decides what help you get. Fè tès plasman anglè a. Pa enkyete w — li sèlman deside ki èd w ap jwenn.

DAY 5 · JOU 5

Try one club, team or activity. Say hello to one new person. Eseye yon klib, yon ekip oswa yon aktivite. Di yon nouvo moun bonjou.

Three sentences that open doors: "Can you say that again, please?" · "Can you show me?" · "I need help. Who can I ask?" Teachers expect new students to ask. Nobody will be upset.

Twa fraz ki louvri pòt: "Can you say that again, please?" (Ou ka repete sa, souple?) · "Can you show me?" (Ou ka montre m?) · "I need help. Who can I ask?" (Mwen bezwen èd. Ki moun mwen ka mande?) Pwofesè yo atann pou nouvo elèv poze kesyon. Pèsoun pap fache.

4 A typical school day

Yon jou lekòl tipik

A middle / high school day · *Yon jou nan middle school oswa high school*

Times are examples. Elementary students stay with one teacher and have recess instead of changing rooms. · Lè yo se egzanp. Nan lekòl primè elèv yo rete ak yon sèl pwofesè epi yo gen rekreyasyon olye yo chanje sal.

7:15	Bus or drop-off. Be at the stop 5 minutes early; the bus does not wait.
7:45	First bell. Go straight to 1st period. Arriving after the bell = tardy .
7:50–9:20	Periods / blocks. 4–7 classes a day, 50–90 min. each. You move; the teacher stays.
3–5 min	Passing time between classes. Use the bathroom and locker now.
11:30	Lunch in the cafeteria (30 min.). Buy, or bring food from home. Free/reduced lunch: page 6.
2:45	Dismissal. Buses leave within 10 minutes.
3:00–5:00	After school: sports, clubs, tutoring, band. Free and open to you.

7:15	Bis oswa depoze. Rive 5 minit anvan; bis la pa tann.
7:45	Premye klòch. Ale dirèkteman nan 1ye klas la. Rive apre klòch la = tardy (an reta).
7:50–9:20	Peryòd / blòk. 4–7 klas pa jou, 50–90 min. chak. Se ou ki deplase; pwofesè a rete.
3–5 min	Tan pasaj ant klas yo. Sèvi ak twalèt la ak kazyè a kounye a.
11:30	Manje midi nan kafeterya a (30 min.). Achte, oswa pote manje lakay. Manje gratis/pri redui: paj 6.
2:45	Sòti. Bis yo pati nan 10 minit.
3:00–5:00	Apre lekòl: espò, klib, leson patikilye, fanfa. Gratis epi louvri pou ou.

Things that surprise newcomers

- **Hall pass:** to leave class you ask the teacher and carry a pass.
- **Lockers** have a combination lock. Write the numbers down; practice at home.
- **Announcements** and the Pledge of Allegiance come over a speaker each morning. Standing is customary; you may stay silent.
- **Fire drills, tornado drills, lockdown drills** are practice. Follow the teacher quietly.
- **Students eat with friends**, not by class. It is OK to sit with anyone, and to ask "Can I sit here?"
- **PE (physical education)** may require changing clothes in a locker room.
- **Homework** is daily in most classes and counts toward your grade.

Bagay ki sezi nouvo elèv yo

- **Pèmi koulwa (hall pass):** pou w soti nan klas la ou mande pèmisyon epi ou pote yon pèmi.
- **Kazyè yo** gen yon kadna ak konbinezon. Ekri nimewo yo; pratike lakay.
- **Anons yo** ak Sèman Fidelite Drapo a (Pledge of Allegiance) pase nan wopalè a chak maten. Abitid la se kanpe; ou ka rete an silans.
- **Egzèsis** pou dife, tònad ak lockdown (fèmen lekòl la) se pratik. Suiv pwofesè a an silans.
- **Elèv yo manje ak zanmi**, pa pa klas. Ou ka chita ak nenpòt moun epi mande "Can I sit here?"
- **Edikasyon fizik (PE)** ka mande pou w chanje rad nan yon vestyè.
- **Devwa** se chak jou nan prèske tout klas epi li konte nan nòt ou.

If you are absent

- A parent calls or writes a note the **same day** — the school will call home otherwise.
- Ask every teacher for the **make-up work**. You usually get as many days as you missed.
- Many absences (even excused) can trigger a meeting or affect credit. Attendance matters a lot in the U.S.

Cell phones: most schools now require phones off and away during class — some all day. Check your school's rule the first week so you never lose it to the office.

Si w absan

- Yon paran rele oswa voye yon nòt **menm jou a** — sinon, lekòl la ap rele lakay.
- Mande chak pwofesè **travay pou w ratrape**. Anjeneral ou gen menm kantite jou ou te absan yo.
- Anpil absans (menm ak eskiz) ka lakòz yon reyinyon oswa afekte kredi yo. Ozetazini, prezans konte anpil.

Telefòn selilè: pifò lekòl egzije pou telefòn nan etenn epi sere pandan klas — gen kèk ki egzije sa tout jounen an. Tcheke règ lekòl ou a premye semèn nan pou yo pa janm pran l nan men w.

5 Classes, grades and graduation

Klas, nòt ak gradyasyon

Letter grades · Nòt an lèt

A 90–100 Excellent · Ekselan	B 80–89 Good · Byen	C 70–79 Average · Mwayen	D 60–69 Passing, weak · Pase, men fèb	F below 60 Failing · Echwe
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Some districts use other cut-offs (A = 93+). Your grade in a class mixes homework, class work, quizzes, tests and projects — so **turning in every assignment** matters as much as test scores. A missing assignment is a 0.

Gen distri ki itilize lòt limit (A = 93+). Nòt ou nan yon klas melanje devwa, travay nan klas, quiz, egzamen ak pwojè — kidonk **remèt tout devwa yo** konte menm jan ak egzamen yo. Yon devwa ou pa remèt se yon 0.

Words on your report card

- **Report card** — grades for each class, every quarter or semester.
- **Progress report** — a mid-term warning of how you are doing.
- **GPA** (grade point average) — your grades as a number, 0–4.0. A = 4, B = 3, C = 2, D = 1. Colleges look at it.
- **Transcript** — the official list of every high school class and grade.
- **Honor roll** — a list of students with high grades. Celebrate it!

Mo sou kanè w

- **Report card** — kanè ak nòt chak klas, chak trimès oswa semès.
- **Progress report** — yon avètisman nan mitan peryòd la sou kijan w ap mache.
- **GPA** (mwayèn) — nòt ou yo an chif, soti 0 rive 4.0. A = 4, B = 3, C = 2, D = 1. Inivèsite yo gade l.
- **Transcript** — lis ofisyèl tout klas ak nòt lekòl segondè w.
- **Honor roll** — tablo donè pou elèv ki gen gwo nòt. Seleb्रे !!

Graduating from high school · Gradye nan lekòl segondè

Requirement · Egzijans	English	Kreyòl
Credits · Kredi	Most states require about 22–26 credits . One year-long class = 1 credit. You need 4 English, 3–4 math, 3–4 science, 3–4 social studies, plus electives.	Pifò eta mande apeprè 22–26 kredi . Yon klas ki dire tout ane a = 1 kredi. Ou bezwen 4 anglè, 3–4 matematik, 3–4 syans, 3–4 syans sosyal, plis klas opsyonèl.
Passing · Pase	A D or better usually earns the credit. An F means retaking the class (summer school or credit recovery).	Ak yon D oswa pi bon ou anjeneral jwenn kredi a. Yon F vle di refè klas la (lekòl ete oswa rekiperasyon kredi).
State tests · Egzamen eta yo	Some states require end-of-course tests in English, algebra, biology or U.S. history. EL students may get extra time or a bilingual dictionary.	Gen eta ki egzije egzamen fen kou nan anglè, aljèb, byoloji oswa istwa Etazini. Elèv EL yo ka jwenn tan siplemantè oswa yon diksyonè bileng.
Diploma vs. GED	A diploma comes from finishing high school. A GED is a test adults can take instead. The diploma is better for college and jobs.	Diplòm nan soti lè w fini lekòl segondè. GED la se yon egzamen granmoun ka pase nan plas li. Diplòm nan pi bon pou inivèsite ak travay.

Kinds of classes

- **Required / core** — English, math, science, social studies.
- **Electives** — your choice: art, band, computer science, Spanish, welding, culinary...
- **Honors, AP, dual credit** — harder classes that can earn college credit. Ask your counselor; EL students can take them.
- **ESL / ELD** — your English development class. It counts for credit.

Credits from your home country count. Bring any transcript or report card, even without a translation. Your counselor and EL teacher can evaluate it and give you credit for classes you already passed.

Kalite klas

- **Obligatwa / de baz** — anglè, matematik, syans, syans sosyal.
- **Opsyonèl (electives)** — se ou ki chwazi: atizay, fanfa, enfòmatrik, panyòl, soudi, kizin...
- **Honors, AP, kredi doub** — klas ki pi difisil ki ka bay kredi inivèsite. Mande konseye a; elèv EL yo ka pran yo tou.
- **ESL / ELD** — klas devlopman anglè w. Li konte kòm kredi.

Kredi ki soti nan peyi w konte. Pote nenpòt sètifika oswa kanè, menm si li pa tradui. Konseye a ak pwofesè EL la ka evalye l epi ba w kredi pou klas ou te deja pase yo.

6 Your rights and EL support

Dwa w ak sipò pou aprenan anglè

Six rights every student has, by U.S. law · Sis dwa lalwa garanti w

A free public education

Every child living in the district can enroll, whatever their immigration status (*Plyler v. Doe*, 1982). Schools may not ask for papers or a Social Security number. Educación pública gratuita para todo niño del distrito, sin importar su estatus migratorio. No pueden pedir papeles ni número de Seguro Social.

Information in your language

Important notices — enrollment, grades, discipline, special education, meetings — must be translated or interpreted for parents, free.

Avisos importantes traducidos o interpretados para los padres, gratis.

Help for disabilities

If learning is hard for reasons beyond language, you can be evaluated for an IEP or 504 plan. Being an EL is **not**

a disability, and cannot block the evaluation.

Si aprender es difícil por razones más allá del idioma, puedes ser evaluado para un IEP o plan 504.

Language help in school

Schools must give English learners real language instruction and access to the same classes as everyone (Civil Rights Act Title VI; *Lau v. Nichols*; EEOA).

La escuela debe dar instrucción de inglés real y acceso a las mismas clases que los demás.

Free or low-cost meals

Families with lower incomes get free or reduced-price breakfast and lunch. One form, in the office, in your language. Some schools feed everyone free.

Desayuno y almuerzo gratis o a bajo costo. Un solo formulario, en la oficina, en tu idioma.

A safe school

Bullying, harassment and discrimination because of your language, country or religion are against the law. Report it to any adult; the school must act.

El acoso y la discriminación por tu idioma, país o religión son ilegales. Repórtalo a cualquier adulto.

What EL support looks like

- **The test:** after the Home Language Survey, you take a short English screener. If you qualify, you are an **English learner (EL)**.
- **Levels:** most states use levels 1 (beginning) to 5 (advanced). Your level sets your supports — it does not lower your grade.
- **Services:** an ESL/ELD class, a co-teacher in content classes, sheltered classes, or a bilingual program. Parents may decline services, but the school must still help you.
- **Accommodations** on class work and state tests: extra time, a bilingual dictionary, directions read aloud, small group.
- **Yearly test** (ELPA21, WIDA ACCESS, ELPAC...) each spring measures listening, speaking, reading and writing. Reach the exit score and you leave the program, then get 2–4 years of monitoring.

Kijan sipò EL la ye

- **Tès la:** apre Sondaj sou Lang Lakay la, ou fè yon ti tès anglè kout. Si w kalifye, ou se yon **aprenan anglè (EL)**.
- **Nivo yo:** prèske tout eta itilize nivo 1 (debitan) rive 5 (avanse). Nivo w deside ki sipò w ap jwenn — li pa bese nòt ou.
- **Sèvis yo:** yon klas ESL/ELD, yon ko-pwofesè nan klas matyè yo, klas pwoteje (sheltered) oswa yon pwogram bileng. Paran yo ka refize sèvis yo, men lekòl la dwe toujou ede w.
- **Akomodasyon** nan devwa ak egzamen eta yo: tan siplemantè, diksyonè bileng, enstriksyon yo li awotvwa, ti gwoup.
- **Tès anyèl** (ELPA21, WIDA ACCESS, ELPAC...) chak prentan mezire koute, pale, li ak ekri. Lè w rive nan nòt sòti a, ou kite pwogram nan epi yo swiv ou pandan 2–4 an.

If something feels wrong: ask the counselor first, then the principal, then the district's EL coordinator or Title III director. You can also file a complaint with the state department of education or the U.S. Office for Civil Rights. Write down dates and names.

Si yon bagay pa bon: pale ak konseye a anvan, apre sa direktè a, apre sa kowòdonatè EL oswa direktè Title III distri a. Ou ka depoze yon plent tou nan departman edikasyon eta a oswa nan Biwo Dwa Sivil Etazini an (Office for Civil Rights). Ekri dat ak non yo.

7 Classroom culture and unwritten rules

Kilti sal klas la ak règ ki pa ekri yo

What may be different from your old school · *Sa ki ka diferan*

Topic · Sijè	In most U.S. schools...	Nan pifò lekòl Etazini...
Speaking up Pran lapawòl	Teachers want you to ask questions, give opinions and even disagree politely. Raise your hand and wait to be called on. Silence can look like not caring.	Pwofesè yo vle pou w poze kesyon, bay opinyon w e menm pa dakò ak respè. Leve men w epi tann yo rele w. Silans ka parèt tankou ou pa enterese.
Respect Respè	Students call teachers "Mr. / Ms. + last name." Looking an adult in the eye is a sign of respect, not defiance. Standing when a teacher enters is not expected.	Elèv yo rele pwofesè yo "Mr. / Ms. + siyati". Gade yon granmoun nan je se yon siy respè, se pa defi. Yo pa atann pou w kanpe lè pwofesè a antre.
Group work Travay an gwoup	Very common. Everyone is expected to talk and share the work. Helping on a <i>test</i> , though, is cheating.	Trè komen. Yo atann pou tout moun pale epi pataje travay la. Men, ede yon moun nan yon <i>egzamen</i> se triche.
Honesty Onètete	Copying homework, copying from the internet, or using AI to write for you is plagiarism and can mean a 0 or worse. Use your own words; cite sources.	Kopye devwa, kopye sou entènèt, oswa sèvi ak entelijans atifisyèl (AI) pou ekri pou ou se plajya epi sa ka bay yon 0 oswa pi mal. Sèvi ak pwòp mo pa w; site sous yo.
Personal space Espas pèsònèl	People stand about an arm's length apart. Hugs and kisses on the cheek are not common greetings at school; a smile, a nod or "Hey" is.	Moun kanpe apeprè longè yon bra youn ak lòt. Anbrase ak bo sou machwè se pa salitasyon komen nan lekòl; yon souri, yon siy tèt oswa "Hey" se sa ki komen.
Time Ponktyalite	On time means <i>before</i> the bell. Deadlines are real: late work often loses points every day.	Alè vle di <i>anvan</i> klòch la. Dat limit yo reyèl: travay an reta souvan pèdi pwèn chak jou.
Dress code Kòd abiman	Most schools have rules (no hats inside, covered shoulders/midriff, no offensive words). Some require uniforms. Ask for the handbook.	Pifò lekòl gen règ (pa gen chapo anndan, zepòl ak vant kouvri, pa gen mo ofansan). Gen kèk ki egziye inifòm. Mande manyèl la.

Discipline: how it usually works

- **Warning → call home → detention → ISS → OSS.** Detention is staying after school. ISS (in-school suspension) is a day in a separate room. OSS (out-of-school) means you stay home — and may miss work.
- Fighting, weapons, drugs and threats are the most serious. Even "joking" threats are taken seriously.
- You and your parents have the right to hear the reason, in your language, and to tell your side.

Disiplin: kijan li fonksyone anjeneral

- **Avètisman → apèl lakay → detention → ISS → OSS.** Detention se rete apre lekòl. ISS (sispansyon anndan lekòl la) se yon jou nan yon sal apa. OSS (sispansyon deyò lekòl la) vle di ou rete lakay — epi ou ka pèdi travay.
- Goumen, zam, dwòg ak menas se bagay ki pi grav. Menm menas "pou blag" yo pran yo oserye.
- Ou menm ak paran w gen dwa konnen rezon an, nan lang nou, epi bay vèsyon pa nou.

Making friends

- Join **one thing**: soccer, band, art club, robotics, a church group. Friendships in the U.S. often start in activities, not in class.
- Sit with the same people at lunch two days in a row — that is how a table becomes yours.
- Your language and your country are interesting to others. Share them.
- Feeling lonely or sad for the first months is normal. Tell the counselor; that is their job.

Keep your first language. Reading, writing and thinking in it makes your English stronger, not weaker. Bilingual graduates earn more and many states give a **Seal of Biliteracy** on the diploma.

Fè zanmi

- Antre nan **yon bagay**: foutbòl, fanfa, klib atizay, wobotik, yon gwoup legliz. Ozetazini, zanmitay souvan kòmanse nan aktivite, pa nan klas.
- Chita ak menm moun yo nan manje midi de jou youn apre lòt — se konsa yon tab vin tab pa w.
- Lang ou ak peyi w enteresan pou lòt moun. Pataje yo.
- Santi w poukont ou oswa tris nan premye mwa yo nòmal. Di konseye a; se pou sa li la.

Kenbe premye lang ou. Li, ekri ak panse nan lang sa a ranfòse anglè w, li pa febli l. Gradye bileng yo touche plis lajan, epi anpil eta bay yon **So Bialfabetizasyon** (Seal of Biliteracy) sou diplòm nan.

8 For families

Pou fanmi yo

In the U.S., schools expect parents to be **partners**. Teachers are not offended by questions — they read it as caring. You do not need perfect English, a car, or free time during the day to be involved.

How the school will contact you

- **Phone calls and texts** — automated absence calls, weather closings, emergencies. Keep your number updated in the office.
- **A parent app or portal** (PowerSchool, Skyward, ParentSquare, ClassDojo, Remind...) with grades, attendance and messages. Ask the office to set it up in your language.
- **Papers in the backpack** — permission slips, field trips, picture day. Check it every night; sign and return.
- **Email** — most teachers answer within a day. Short is fine: "Hello, I am Ana's mother. How is she doing in math? Thank you."

Meetings you will be invited to

- **Open house / Back-to-School Night** (August–September) — walk your child's schedule and meet every teacher. Go.
- **Parent-teacher conferences** (fall and spring) — 10–15 minutes per teacher. Ask: What is my child doing well? What should we practice at home? How can I reach you?
- **EL / LPAC meeting** — about English placement and services. You may bring someone you trust.
- **IEP / 504 meeting** — only if your child is evaluated for extra support. You are a full member of the team.
- **You can request a meeting any time.** An interpreter must be provided free — ask when you schedule.

Ozetazini, lekòl yo atann pou paran yo se **patnè**. Kesyon pa deranje pwofesè yo — yo wè sa kòm enterè. Ou pa bezwen anglè pafè, machin ni tan lib lajounen pou w patisipe.

Kijan lekòl la ap kontakte w

- **Apèl ak mesaj tèks** — apèl otomatik pou absans, fèmti akòz move tan, ijans. Kenbe nimewo w ajou nan biwo a.
- **Yon aplikasyon oswa pòtay pou paran** (PowerSchool, Skyward, ParentSquare, ClassDojo, Remind...) ak nòt, prezans ak mesaj. Mande biwo a pou konfigire l nan lang ou.
- **Papye nan sakado a** — pèmisyon, ekskisyon, jou foto. Tcheke l chak swa; siyen epi retounen l.
- **Imèl** — prèske tout pwofesè reponn nan yon jou. Yon mesaj kout bon: "Hello, I am Ana's mother. How is she doing in math? Thank you."

Reyinyon y ap envite w

- **Open house / Swa Retou Lekòl** (out-septanm) — suiv orè pitit ou epi rankontre chak pwofesè. Ale.
- **Konferans paran-pwofesè** (otòn ak prentan) — 10–15 minit pa pwofesè. Mande: Kisa pitit mwen fè byen? Kisa nou ta dwe pratike lakay? Kijan mwen ka kontakte w?
- **Reyinyon EL / LPAC** — sou plasman ak sèvis anglè yo. Ou ka mennen yon moun ou fè konfyans.
- **Reyinyon IEP / 504** — sèlman si y ap evalye pitit ou pou sipò siplemantè. Ou se yon manm konplè nan ekip la.
- **Ou ka mande yon reyinyon nenpòt lè.** Yo dwe ba w yon entèprèt gratis — mande l lè w ap pran randevou a.

Helping at home — even without English · *Ede lakay, menm san anglè*

Ask every day: "What did you learn? What is due?"

Mande chak jou: "Kisa w aprann? Kisa ou gen pou w remèt?"

Keep a quiet time and place for homework, with the Chromebook charged.

Fikse yon lè ak yon kote trankil pou devwa, ak Chromebook la chaje.

Read, talk and tell stories in your home language. It builds the thinking English needs.

Li, pale epi rakonte istwa nan lang lakay ou. Sa bati panse anglè a bezwen an.

Check the parent app once a week for grades and missing work.

Tcheke aplikasyon paran an yon fwa pa semèn pou nòt ak travay ki manke.

Send your child every day, on time. Attendance is the strongest predictor of success.

Voye pitit ou chak jou, alè. Prezans se pi gwo siy siksè.

Let your child teach you a word of English each night.

Kite pitit ou aprann ou yon mo anglè chak swa.

Fill in for your school · *Ranpli pou lekòl ou*

School · Lekòl:

Main office phone · Telefòn biwo prensipal la:

Counselor · Konseye:

EL teacher · Pwofesè EL:

Interpreter / liaison · Entèprèt / Iyezon:

Bus number · Nimewo bis:

Parent app · Aplikasyon pou paran:

School hours · Orè lekòl:

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9 Words to know

Mo ou dwe konnen — English · kreyòl · meaning

School & people · Lekòl ak moun

Principal	direktè/direktris — leads the school
Assistant principal	direktè adjwen — discipline, schedules
Counselor	konseye — schedules, problems, college
Front office	biwo — where you check in, sign out
Custodian	konsyèj — keeps the building clean
Substitute (sub)	pwofesè ranplasan — fills in for a teacher
Paraprofessional	asistan — helps the teacher
Cafeteria	kafeterya — where you eat lunch
Gym	jimnazyòm — PE and sports
Media center	bibliyotèk — library
Locker	kazyè — storage with a lock
Hallway	koulwa
Restroom	twalèt — also "bathroom"
Bus loop	zòn bis yo
Car rider line	liy pou machin vin chèche elèv
Field trip	ekskisyon — needs a signed form
Handbook	manyèl — the school's rules
PTA / PTO	asosyasyon paran
School board	konsèy eskolè — elected district leaders
Superintendent	sipèentandan — district leader

Classes & grades · Klas ak nòt

Period / block	peryòd / blòk — one class time
Schedule	orè
Syllabus	pwogram — the class plan and rules
Assignment	devwa / travay
Due date	dat pou remèt
Late work	travay an reta — loses points
Quiz	ti tès kout
Test / exam	egzamen
Midterm / final	egzamen mi-semès / final
Rubric	ribrik — how work is scored
Extra credit	pwen siplemantè
Make-up work	travay ratrapaj
Report card	kanè
GPA	mwayèn — 0–4.0
Credit	kredi — toward graduation
Transcript	dosye akademik
Elective	klas opsyonèl
Honors / AP	avanse — harder, college credit
Tutoring	leson patikilye — free extra help
Office hours	lè konsiltasyon — time to see a teacher

Rules, EL & support · Règ, EL ak sipò

Tardy	an reta — late to class
Absent / excused	absan / ak eskiz
Truancy	absans san eskiz — too many unexcused absences; legal issue
Hall pass	pèmi koulwa
Detention	pinisyon apre lekòl
ISS / OSS	sispansyon anndan / deyò
Referral	rapò disiplinè
Dress code	kòd abiman
Bullying	entimidasyon — report it
Lockdown drill	egzèsis fèmen lekòl la
EL / ELL / ESL	aprenan anglè — you, and your program
Newcomer	nouvo arivan — first 1–2 years in U.S.
Home language survey	sonday sou lang lakay
Placement test	tès plasman
Accommodation	akomodasyon — extra time, dictionary
Interpreter	entèprèt — spoken; free
Translation	tradiksyon — written; free
IEP / 504 plan	plan sipò pou andikap
Free / reduced lunch	manje midi gratis / pri redui
Seal of Biliteracy	So Bialfabetizasyon

Phrases for your first month

"Where is room ____?" · "I am new. Can you help me?" · "I don't understand yet." · "How do you say ____ in English?" · "Can I have more time?" · "May I use the restroom?" · "What is the homework?" · "When is it due?"

Fraz pou premye mwa w

Ki kote sal ____ la ye? · Mwen nouvo. Ou ka ede m? · Mwen poko konprann. · Kijan yo di ____ an anglè? · Ou ka ban m plis tan? · Mwen ka ale nan twalèt? · Ki devwa a? · Pou ki lè li ye?

